

A grave responsibility 0'10" - 3'00"



Help !

- **charge** = accusation made against a suspect
- **tried** = examined in court to decide whether the accused is guilty or innocent.
- **the bench** = the judge or magistrate
- **mandatory** = required by law, compulsory

Focus on the American justice system (0'10" - 1'13')

Explain what effects are created by the use of:

a- a low-angle shot in the scene outside the building (0'10" to 0'27")

b- a high-angle shot on entering the building (0'27" to 0'40")

c- an eye-level shot and an continuous take leading to the courtroom (0'40" to 1'13")

Focus on the judge's instructions

Fill in the blanks. Then highlight in blue the juror's tasks and in red elements showing how important their duty is.

To continue, you've listened to a long and complex _____: _____ in the first degree. _____ is the most serious charge tried in our criminal courts. You've listened to the _____, you've had the law read to you and interpreted as it applies in this case. It's now your _____ to sit down and try to separate the _____ from the fancy. One man is dead. Another man's life is _____. If there is a reasonable _____ in your minds as to the _____ of the accused, a reasonable _____, then you must bring me a _____ of 'Not Guilty'. If, however, there's no reason-

-ble _____, then you must, in good conscience, find the accused "_____". However you decide, your _____ must be _____. In the event that you find the accused _____, the bench will not entertain a recommendation for mercy. The _____ is mandatory in this case. You're faced with a grave _____. Thank you, gentlemen.

Focus on the atmosphere

a- In the part of the scene before we enter room 228: explain what can be misleading for the spectators.

b- Contrast the judge's words and his attitudes.

c- Contrast the way the jury is filmed and the way the accused is shown. What is the impact on the spectators?

d- Recap: Explain what these false leads and oppositions warn the spectators about.

Focus on tension



Look at this film still and explain how a sense of tension is built.